

Experiment No. 2

Setting Up a Zoho Creator Account and Exploring the Platform Architecture and Interface

1. Aim

To create and set up a Zoho Creator account, develop a simple sample application, and explore the creation of forms, reports, and dashboards. The experiment also aims to understand the main sections of the Zoho Creator platform, namely **Develop, Deploy, and Manage**.

2. Setting Up Zoho Creator

Step 1: Creating a Zoho Creator Account

The following steps were followed to create a Zoho Creator account:

1. Opened the Zoho Creator website.
2. Signed up using an email address or Google account.
3. Verified the registered email address.
4. Logged in to the Zoho Creator platform.
5. Opened the Zoho Creator dashboard.

Step 2: Creating a Sample Application

After logging in, a sample application was created by following these steps:

1. Clicked on **Create New Application**.
2. Selected **Blank Application**.
3. Entered the application name.
4. Clicked **Create** to create the application.

I) Sample Application – Corporate Asset

A sample application named **Corporate Asset** was created to understand the basic features of Zoho Creator. The application was designed to store and manage information about company assets.

The application contains **forms** for entering asset details, **reports** for viewing and managing the stored records, and a **dashboard** for displaying important information visually. Creating this application helped in understanding how Zoho Creator can be used to build applications with less coding.

II) Creating Form, Report, and Dashboard

A. Creating a Form

A **form** is used to collect and store information from users. It provides an interface where users can enter details and submit them to the application.

Different types of fields can be added to a form, such as:

- Single Line
- Multi Line
- Number
- Date
- Email
- Phone Number
- Dropdown
- Checkbox
- Radio Button
- Lookup
- File Upload

To create a form, **Create** → **Form** was selected. A suitable form name was entered and the required fields were added using the drag-and-drop interface.

The properties of each field can also be configured. For example, a field can be made mandatory, given a default value, or provided with validation rules.

Forms help in collecting data in an organized way. They also make it possible to validate the entered information and perform calculations or automated actions when required.

A screenshot of a web application interface. The browser address bar shows a URL from 'creatorapp.zoho.in'. The application has a dark sidebar on the left with a menu containing 'DEPARTMENT', 'DEPARTMENT Report', 'Asset Details', 'Technician', 'Maintenance Request', 'Maintenance Approval', and 'Repair Progress'. The main content area is titled 'DEPARTMENT' and contains a form with the following fields: 'Department Name' (a single-line text input), 'Department Head' (two side-by-side text inputs for 'First Name' and 'Last Name'), 'Department Location' (a single-line text input), 'Address Line 1' (a single-line text input), 'Address Line 2' (a single-line text input), 'City / District' (a text input), 'State / Province' (a dropdown menu), 'Postal Code' (a text input), and 'Country' (a dropdown menu). A blue 'Submit' button is located at the bottom of the form. The top of the application shows a 'View as' dropdown set to '-MySelf-' and a 'Trial expires in 9 days' notification.

B. Creating a Report

A **report** is used to display the records that have been entered through a form. Whenever a user submits a form, the information is stored and can later be viewed through a report.

To create a report, **Create** → **Report** was selected and the required form was chosen. Different report formats are available, including:

- List Report
- Summary Report
- Calendar Report
- Kanban Report
- Spreadsheet Report

The report can be customized by selecting the required fields, applying filters, sorting records, grouping information, and adding search options.

Reports are useful for quickly viewing and managing stored records. They allow users to search, edit, update, or delete information when required.

Department ID	Department Name	Department Head	Department Location
3	CSD	Vinodh Kumar	D block
2	AIML	Ayyadurai	A block
1	Computer Science and Engineering	Manoranjani	A block

C. Creating a Dashboard

A **dashboard** provides a visual summary of the information stored in an application. It can display data using charts, tables, widgets, and Key Performance Indicators (KPIs).

To create a dashboard, **Create → Dashboard** was selected and a suitable name was given. Different components such as charts, reports, gauges, statistics widgets, buttons, and embedded pages can be added to the dashboard.

These components can be arranged and resized based on the required layout.

Dashboards are useful because they provide important information in one place. They make it easier to understand data, monitor important statistics, and make decisions without having to open individual reports.

3. Exploring the Zoho Creator Platform Architecture and Interface

Zoho Creator mainly provides three important sections for building and managing applications: **Develop, Deploy, and Manage**.

A. Develop

The **Develop** section is where the application is created and customized. It provides tools to build different components such as forms, reports, pages, dashboards, workflows, and schedules.

The drag-and-drop interface makes application development easier. Field properties can be configured, relationships between forms can be created, and workflows can be added to automate tasks.

For advanced requirements, **Deluge scripting** can be used to add additional functionality and business logic. External services can also be connected through integrations.

Overall, the Develop section is the main area used for designing and building the application.

B. Deploy

The **Deploy** section is used to make the completed application available to its users.

After developing and testing an application, it can be made accessible through web browsers and supported devices. User access and permissions can also be configured based on their roles.

The application can be shared with selected users or organizations, and updates can be published whenever changes are made.

Thus, the Deploy section helps in moving the application from the development stage to actual usage.

C. Manage

The **Manage** section is mainly used for administration and maintenance of the application.

Administrators can manage users, roles, permissions, security settings, and application-related configurations. It also provides options for monitoring application usage and maintaining the application.

Other activities such as managing backups, restoring data, monitoring storage, configuring integrations, and checking user activities can also be performed.

Therefore, the Manage section helps keep the application secure, reliable, and properly maintained after deployment.

Result

Thus, a **Zoho Creator account was successfully created** and a sample **Corporate Asset** application was developed. Forms, reports, and a dashboard were created to understand how data can be collected, stored, displayed, and analyzed.

The **Develop, Deploy, and Manage** sections of Zoho Creator were also explored. Through this experiment, the basic architecture and interface of Zoho Creator were understood, and it was observed that the platform allows applications to be developed quickly with minimal coding using a low-code approach.